

How I Run a \$15M Company and Still Go Out Every Weekend

Channel: Tim Luong · Published: Aug 12, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9Z6rwNip7yg> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Tim Luong reveals the framework behind running \$15M+/year while working 20–25 hours a week: fire non-A-players fast, protect a 3-hour morning deep work block, focus only on three CEO jobs, and systematize recurring problems.

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The Counterintuitive First Move: Let Revenue Drop 0:47

- Tim's default solution early on was to hire more people whenever something went wrong
 - Result: he got dragged into more meetings he shouldn't have been in
 - Most of his time went to managing people who couldn't do their work
- He made the decision to let all underperforming team members go at once
 - Counterintuitively, removing them made problems *smaller* — he could deal with issues directly instead of through a middleman who was creating friction
 - It freed up time to focus on hiring the *right* person because he now knew exactly what traits to look for
- **Revenue dropped 40–50% in the 90 days after he made these cuts**
 - But because he no longer had the overhead of those employees, the business survived
 - He knew that rebuilding with the right foundation and A-players would make things significantly better within 90 days
- Key distinction he learned:
 - First time hiring → hiring for **relief** (pressure-release hires)
 - Second time hiring → hiring for **leverage** (strategic, intentional hires)

- He has had to repeat this process multiple times as the company scaled
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